AN ECLECTIC TECHNOLOGIES FOUNDATIONAL DEFINITION

FD-BR — The Broker

Foundational Definition: The Human-Judgment Role That Discharges a Bright Line's Authorization Obligation, Its Pairing to a Line, the Competence That Qualifies It, and the Conditions Under Which a Verified Gatekeeper May Stand in for Its Presence

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Audience: Standards and policy reviewers; sector regulators; compliance officers and legal counsel; framework authors; individuals appointed to Command Broker or Influence Broker roles
Parent: None. This instrument defines. See §2.
Companion root definitions: FD-BL and FD-SBL — the Bright Lines whose §4.5 obligation a Broker discharges; and FD-LD, FD-EV and FD-LS. FD-BR owns the Broker role-type; the Lines own the placement criteria that determine each Broker's competence domain.

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1. Purpose and the Defect This Instrument Corrects

Every Bright Line in the corpus creates an obligation: an action placed above the line requires substantive, attributable human authorization. The human who supplies that authorization is the Broker. The corpus already names two — the **Command Broker (CB)**, which authorizes above-line actions in

industrial and control settings, and the **Influence Broker (IB)**, which authorizes above-line actions in the surveillance and democratic-process setting.

When this instrument first issued, the roles existed but were not defined at the foundational level. They were introduced inside the Command Broker Framework, Cross-Sector, and elaborated in the CB-IB Qualification and Onboarding Standard — that is, *downstream* of the frameworks that consume them. Three defects followed.

First, a role defined inside a framework drifts with that framework. Each document that uses "the Broker" can restate it, and nothing binds the restatements together.

Second, the relationship between a Broker and a Bright Line has never been stated as an invariant. Because it is unstated, nothing prevents the category error of assuming one Broker role covers more than one Line — the error FD-SBL was written to guard against when it insisted a Command Broker is not an Influence Broker.

Third, the term itself varies: the surveillance corpus writes "Influence Broker," while the CB-IB Qualification Standard writes "Influencer Broker." Same role, two spellings, no reservation.

This instrument defines the Broker role-type once, states the Line ↔ Broker pairing invariant, fixes the competence and accountability rules, sets the conditions under which architecture may substitute for a Broker, names the two current instantiations, and reserves the term.

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2. Authority, Family, and Convention

2.1 Precedence

This instrument owns the definition of the Broker for all documents in the corpus, across both the industrial (FD-BL) and democratic-safeguards (FD-SBL) lines.

Foundational Definitions take precedence over frameworks, qualification standards, sector documents, and implementation guidance. The Command Broker Framework, the CB-IB Qualification and Onboarding Standard, FD-BL §4.5, and FD-SBL §4.5 are restatements or implementations of the role defined here. A framework or qualification standard may specify a Broker's sector procedures, competency instruments, and disclosure architecture; it shall not vary the role definition (§4.1), the pairing invariant (§4.2), the competence rule (§4.3), the substitution rule (§4.4), or the accountability rule (§4.5). Propagation shall be by reference to this instrument, not by restating text.

2.2 The Foundational Definitions family

FD-BR qualifies under the family membership test: the correctness of both Bright Line documents and of the qualification standard depends on agreeing what kind of thing a Broker is. It is a root definition — it has dependents and no parent.

2.3 Declaration convention

Per the family convention, this instrument states what kind of thing the Broker is before defining it (§4.1): a role, not an office, not a component, not a procedure.

2.4 What this instrument does not alter

Nothing here alters the competency-assessment content, the disclosure architecture, or the onboarding mechanics carried in the CB-IB Qualification and Onboarding Standard, nor the sector procedures in the Command Broker Framework. Those are inherited unchanged. This instrument is definitional; it states requirements about the role and about conformance to it, not the operational content of any Broker's duties.

2.5 Terminology reservation

"Envelope" and "pre-authorized envelope" are used in this instrument only in the authorization sense reserved by FD-EV. The operational sense, a region whose violation is a runtime event to detect and report, is "operating band."

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3. The Governing Questions

Identity. What kind of thing is a Broker?

Pairing. How does a Broker relate to a Bright Line?

Competence. What qualifies a specific human to hold a Broker role?

Substitution. When, if ever, may a verified gatekeeper stand in for a Broker's presence at the moment of action?

Accountability. Where does responsibility rest, and how is the Broker's independence secured?

The pairing and competence questions are the pair most often collapsed: a corpus that treats "Broker" as a single transferable credential has assumed all Lines share a placement criterion, which they do not.

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4. The Definition

4.1 What kind of thing a Broker is

A Broker is a role: a qualified human who discharges the authorization obligation that a Bright Line places on above-line actions.

It is not an office, not a job title, not a software component, and not a procedure instructing someone to confirm. It is the human-judgment node in the enforcement triad — Line, Gate, Broker — where the Line places the obligation, the Gate is the enforcement interlock, the architecture incapable of executing an above-line action without authorization, which FD-BL §4.5 requires and this instrument defines; and the Broker is the human who authorizes. The Gate never authorizes and never stands in for the Broker. The Broker exists for one reason, inherited from FD-BL §4.5 and FD-SBL §4.5: to supply judgment where proof is unavailable. It is compensation for unverifiability, not a general requirement that consequential actions have human involvement.

The Broker discharges in the mode its Line permits. A Broker discharges the obligation in the moment, or, where the Line document permits it, in advance. In the advance mode the Broker authorizes a pre-

authorized envelope and accepts the proof that bounds it, and a verified gatekeeper then admits each action in the class at runtime (§4.4). The gatekeeper is a different object from the Gate: the Gate holds an action until it is authorized, while the verified gatekeeper admits an action under an authorization the Broker gave in advance. The human discharges; the gatekeeper admits. Where discharge is in advance, the verified gatekeeper's admission is what the Gate accepts as authorization for an action in the class; the Gate itself is unchanged, and an action outside the class, or outside a valid envelope, is held for in-the-moment authorization.

The consequence classifier sits upstream of the triad. It answers placement, which the triad does not address: for each action, whether it is above or below the line. It is owned by FD-BL §4.3 and FD-BL-D1 §5, and an action reaches the triad only once it has been placed above the line.

4.2 The pairing invariant

For every Foundational Bright Line there is exactly one Broker role that discharges its §4.5 obligation.

The Line and its Broker are two halves of one construct. The Line places the obligation; the Broker discharges it; neither is fully specified without the other. A corpus with N Bright Lines has N Broker roles. This is an invariant, not a convention: it holds whether or not a given framework names the Broker explicitly.

The invariant holds across both modes of discharge. Where a Line permits advance discharge, the human who authors, reviews and accepts the pre-authorized envelope, and accepts the proof that bounds it, is that Line's Broker discharging in advance. It is not a second role. The competence that mode requires is a mode-specific competence within the one role (§4.3), and the qualification standard addresses it within that role.

The two current instantiations:

Command Broker (CB) pairs with **FD-BL**, the industrial Bright Line. It authorizes above-line actions whose consequence is measured in facility severity.

Influence Broker (IB) pairs with **FD-SBL**, the Surveillance Bright Line. It authorizes above-line actions whose consequence is measured in harm to democratic self-governance and individual autonomy.

A future Bright Line in the family will generate its own Broker by this invariant; it does not inherit CB or IB.

4.3 Competence is set by the paired Line's placement criterion, and does not transfer

The competence required of a Broker is the competence to judge, on the merits, the actions placed above its Line.

Because placement criteria differ by Line (FD-BL places on facility consequence; FD-SBL on democratic-process consequence), the competence domains differ by Broker. A Command Broker must be competent in process and control consequence — able to evaluate what an incorrect setpoint or control action could cause. An Influence Broker must be competent in the behavioral- and social-science evaluation of influence: able to judge on the merits whether a campaign, taken as a whole, acts on persons' cognition or political behavior in a way its Line places above the line. That is a materially different judgment from the evaluation of process consequence. The Influence Broker must also be competent to authorize actions whose consequence falls on liberty. Those are authorized one at a time, on the indication-integrity requirements and the independent confirmation of the facts they rest on,

with notice to the person and a means to contest (FD-SBL-D1 §3, §4.3, §5). What each judgment is exercised on is set by the Line document (§4.4). Where a Line permits advance discharge, the competence to author an envelope and accept its proof is part of that Line's Broker competence, distinct from in-the-moment competence and held within the same role.

Qualification is therefore Line-specific and non-transferable. Holding one Broker role does not qualify a person for another. A single human may hold two Broker roles only by satisfying both qualification standards independently. A proposal for one "Broker" credential spanning multiple Lines is rejected at the definitional level: it conflates the placement criteria the Line definitions exist to keep apart.

4.4 Substitution: when a verified gatekeeper may stand in for the Broker's presence

The Broker may discharge the obligation in advance, with a verified gatekeeper admitting each action at runtime in the Broker's absence, only where the paired Line's environment is proof-bounded — where the correctness of a narrow, specified class of above-line actions can be proven in advance, over state, trajectory, and rate, in a deterministic and formally verified gatekeeper the proposer cannot modify or bypass. This is the FD-BL-D1 condition (R1–R3), and it is what makes advance discharge defensible in the industrial case: a verified gatekeeper's decision is bounded by proof, as a protective function's behavior is, so judgment is not required at the moment of action where proof is available. **What the verified gatekeeper substitutes for is the Broker's presence at the moment of action, not the Broker's judgment**, which was exercised when the envelope and its proof were accepted. "Substitutable" names that property.

Where the environment is not proof-bounded — where an above-line action's harm is not bounded by proof — no verified gatekeeper can stand in for the Broker's presence, advance discharge is not available, and the Broker's judgment is required at the moment of action, exercised on the unit the paired Line document sets. The rule does not say the harm cannot be verified in principle. It says the proof is not available, and a Line document that applies it states its result on present understanding and names the condition on which it would reopen.

The surveillance Line's value. For the surveillance Line the value is determined at FD-SBL-D2 and stated at FD-SBL §4.5: the Influence Broker is not substitutable, on present understanding. FD-SBL-D1 makes the covert and unverifiable-basis classes non-authorizable and prohibited, so the system shall be incapable of executing them; what the Influence Broker authorizes is the transparent, verifiable-basis class within the permissible-influence boundary (FD-SBL-D1 §4.3). That boundary is a set of criteria checked at authorization, not an envelope in FD-EV's reserved sense, because nothing is authorized in advance by lying inside it. The ground on which this section first stated the surveillance result was withdrawn on 5 September 2026; it is kept in the Record.

The ground of the surveillance value is this section's own proof-bounded rule, on the standard of FD-BL-D1 R2, met by FD-SBL §4.4. R2 requires that a gatekeeper's acceptance set be *proven* a subset of the truly-safe set over state, trajectory and rate, sound and complete across the whole domain the proposer can explore, with no admissible sequence composing into an unsafe path. This section adopts that standard for every Line: advance discharge, in which the Broker authorizes in advance and a verified gatekeeper admits, is available only where that proof can be produced. FD-SBL §4.4 states that the surveillance domain does not supply it. The result follows under this section's rule, which applies R2's standard across Lines; it does not follow from FD-BL-D1 directly, because FD-BL-D1 is a determination under FD-BL and its failure clause names the Command Broker. The ground is determined at FD-SBL-D2 §4. It is reached on the same standard the industrial branch applies, and it gives the opposite result.

Two things about it belong here and the rest belongs to the Line document. The result is stated **on present understanding** rather than foreclosed in principle. **Its reopening is bound wholly by reference to FD-SBL-D2 §6 and §7.3** and is not restated here, except for two points this instrument owns. Reopening is by revision of that determination only, never by a supplier's or an operator's assertion at deployment. And the demonstration it requires is held to this section's own proof-bounded standard. Two classes of action stay fixed regardless of the reopening condition, derived from FD-BL-D1 R3 as FD-SBL-D2 §7.1 carries it across: an action changing the pre-authorized envelope, and an action changing the configuration, limits or logic of any mechanism that admits actions under an authorization given in advance. This section states the shape and binds the value by reference; FD-SBL §4.5 states it.

The unit on which a Broker's judgment is exercised is set by the Line document and binds here by reference, as the substitutability value does. This instrument does not assume that authorization is per action. For the surveillance Line the unit for population-scale influence classes is the campaign, authorized before it runs and held under continuing authority while it runs. Campaign authorization is confined to campaigns fixed at authorization. Liberty actions are authorized individually, within a listing process the Broker also holds as a whole. All of this is stated at FD-SBL §4.5, FD-SBL-D2 §3.1–§3.2 and FD-SBL-D1 §4.3, and none of it is restated here. Where this instrument speaks of a Broker's judgment "in the moment," the moment is the one at which the Line document's unit is authorized.

Substitutability is therefore a property of the paired Line, and it is a spectrum, not a switch. The Command Broker is partially substitutable by a verified gatekeeper for pre-proven action classes, the gatekeeper standing in for its presence at the moment of action and not for its judgment; the Influence Broker is not substitutable on present understanding, on the ground determined at FD-SBL-D2 and stated as this Line's value at FD-SBL §4.5. The degree of Line ↔ Broker coupling is tighter wherever verification is weaker. Each Line document shall state its own substitutability value; this instrument owns the rule that sets it.

4.5 Accountability and independence

Authorization by a Broker shall be substantive and attributable. This instrument owns both terms for every Line, and Line documents cite this section for them rather than restating them. Substantive means the Broker has the information, competence, time, and authority to withhold authorization on the merits. Attributable means the authorization resolves to a named qualified individual and is reconstructable from the audit record.

Accountability for an authorized action rests with the named human Broker and with the deploying authority. On the industrial Line the deploying authority is the asset owner-operator (FD-BL §4.5). No software component holds it. A supplier may build and operate the enforcement architecture; a supplier may not hold the accountability.

Independence is a per-domain design constraint, set by the incentive structure of the paired domain. Where the deploying authority's interest is aligned with correct placement — the ordinary Command Broker case in a commercial or utility setting — procedural independence may suffice. Where the deploying authority benefits from the above-line action — the Influence Broker case, in which the government running an influence operation is also the party the Broker must be able to refuse — independence must be structural, not procedural. Each Broker's qualification standard shall state its independence requirement, and shall justify it from the domain's incentive structure rather than assert it.

5. Worked Examples

These examples are illustrative and interchangeable.

A generative optimizer nominates a setpoint above the line on a gas processing train. The Command Broker, competent in process consequence, authorizes on the merits. For a pre-proven class of nominations inside a pre-authorized envelope whose setback the Command Broker established in advance, the Broker discharges the obligation in advance and a verified gatekeeper admits each nomination (§4.4, FD-BL-D1). The CB is partially substitutable here: the gatekeeper stands in for the Broker's presence at the moment of the nomination, not for the Broker's judgment.

An AI system covertly targets a voter with content tailored to her behavioral profile. After FD-SBL-D1 that action is **prohibited**, not Broker-authorized, because a covert action cannot be substantively authorized by anyone. The system shall be incapable of executing it (FD-SBL §4.5). No Broker is involved.

An agency proposes a transparent, population-scale public-information campaign whose selection of recipients is made by a system component. The Influence Broker authorizes the campaign before it runs, with its content and selection basis fixed at authorization, and holds continuing authority over it while it runs. The Broker's judgment is exercised on the campaign, not on each message (§4.4; FD-SBL-D2 §3.1). No verified gatekeeper can stand in, because the campaign's effect on persons' cognition and political behavior is not bounded by proof (§4.4). The IB is not substitutable, on present understanding.

A system proposes placing a named person on a watch list. The consequence falls on liberty, so the action is authorized individually. The Influence Broker authorizes it only on the indication-integrity requirements and the independent confirmation of the facts it rests on, and the person has notice and a means to contest (FD-SBL-D1 §4.3). The Broker also holds the listing process as a whole.

A person qualified and serving as a Command Broker is asked to sit as an Influence Broker. Absent independent qualification against the IB competence domain, the person is not qualified; process-consequence competence does not carry over to influence judgment (§4.3).

A vendor proposes a single "Broker" credential that covers both industrial and influence deployments. The proposal is rejected at the definitional level: it assumes one placement criterion where there are two (§4.2, §4.3).

A framework specifies that the deploying agency appoints the Influence Broker from its own staff. The specification fails the independence rule (§4.5): in a domain where the deploying authority benefits from the above-line action, the Broker's independence must be structural.

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6. Reserved and Determined Items

6.1 Term reservation — resolved here

"Broker" is reserved for the role-type. "Command Broker (CB)" and "Influence Broker (IB)" are reserved for the two current instantiations. The variant **"Influencer Broker" is non-canonical wherever it appears** and shall be conformed to "Influence Broker" at each carrying instrument's next revision. Conformance is staged per instrument revision, following the reservation model used for "Bright Line" and for "envelope" (FD-EV).

Confirmed by the author, 5 September 2026. v0.1 made this reservation and listed it at §8 as a decision awaiting confirmation. The confirmation is given: "Influence Broker" is canonical. The §8 entry is struck.

The scope statement in v0.1 was wrong and is corrected here. v0.1 named the CB-IB Qualification and Onboarding Standard as *the* site of the variant, which read as an inventory of one. It is not. A reading of the corpus on 5 September finds the variant in eight live masters across three projects; the figure and its method are recorded at §7, dated, because an inventory inside a definitional standard is a snapshot that decays and this instrument states rules rather than counts. **The reservation binds wherever the variant appears, and does not depend on this instrument having listed the site.**

6.2 Substitutability determinations — carried by the Line documents

The Command Broker's substitutability is governed by FD-BL-D1. The Influence Broker's substitutability is delegated to FD-SBL, which states it at §4.5 on the determination of FD-SBL-D2. This instrument owns the substitution rule (§4.4); the per-Line values, and the unit on which each Broker's judgment is exercised, are owned by the Line documents and bind here by reference.

Corrected 5 September 2026, the same day it was written. v0.2 recorded here that FD-SBL existed at two versions in two formats and that this instrument's substitutability result therefore depended on a section whose content differed by which copy a reader opened. **That was false.** The two files in Project 1's folder are one text: 24,306 characters each, character-identical at §6.1 and everywhere else, both declaring Version 0.2 in their own header blocks. Only the markdown's filename says v0.1, and it misreports the version of its own contents. No reader arrives at different text, and nothing here ever depended on which copy was opened.

The error was Project 0's and its shape is worth keeping rather than deleting. The morning's channel note put the matter conditionally — *if* §6.1 differs between the copies — which was the right form for a claim resting on a filename. By the afternoon the condition had been dropped and the claim hardened, on the way into a Foundational Definition, and nobody had opened the file. The version was read off the stem. That is precisely the defect CR-VA was promoted to catch, committed in the same touch that added a dated site-count to §7 *with its method stated*.

The dependency this paragraph recorded is discharged. It read that the substitutability value this section delegates to the Line document was not stated there — that neither FD-SBL nor FD-SBL-D1 used the words *substitutable*, *gatekeeper* or *proof-bounded* anywhere, so the delegation resolved to silence. Project 1 accepted that as its obligation and discharged it the same day: FD-SBL, then at v0.3, stated the value at §4.5 on the determination of FD-SBL-D2, and it still does. FD-SBL-REG holds the branch's version state. The delegation resolves to a value, and this instrument stops reasoning about it — which is what this section was always for.

6.3 Dual-role holding — reserved

Whether, and under what conflict-of-interest constraints, a single human may hold two Broker roles simultaneously. The §4.3 rule permits it only on independent qualification against each; the additional question of whether simultaneous holding creates an impermissible conflict in specific deployment structures is reserved.

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7. Conformance

Command Broker Framework, Cross-Sector — currently the definitional home of the CB and IB roles. Re-scope: the role-type is defined here; the framework becomes an implementing document that cites FD-BR and carries sector procedure only.

CB-IB Qualification and Onboarding Standard — conforming in substance; it already treats both roles as a unified requirement. Update the term “Influencer Broker” to “Influence Broker” (§6.1) and cite FD-BR as the governing role definition.

Where the variant stands — a dated reading, 5 September 2026, not a register. Text was extracted from every .docx and .md master in the eleven project trees, archives and superseded copies excluded, and the two spellings counted. The variant stands at **twenty-nine sites in nine live masters across three projects** — twenty-four in six Project 8 masters, three in two Project 9 masters, and two in one Project 6 master: CB-Framework_Cross_Sector (14), CB-IB_Qualification_Standard (5) and Command_Broker_Implementation_Guide (1) in Project 8’s Command Broker folder; DBA-EN_Series_Introduction (2), DBA-GAS-Sector_Framework (1) and DBA-DC-L1_Design_Basis_Framework (1), also Project 8; DBA-W-Sector_Framework (2) and TAF-W_AI_QA_Water_Sector_Guide (1) in Project 9. and CB-Annex-Nuclear (2) in Project 6. Its frozen NRC_Submittal_Package copy carries two more which are not conformed, per the frozen-deliverable rule, and are outside the figure; its archived v0.1 predecessor carries two more again, which are outside it for the same reason. Project 6 supplied both exclusions so that a later screen walking that tree reports six and does not take the difference for a discrepancy.

The figure divides in a way this reading did not capture, and the division changes what it means. Projects 6 and 9 have since read their own sites against the masters and report that a site may be a *use* of the term or a *quotation* of an instrument’s actual title. A use conforms at its carrying instrument’s next revision, on that project’s own schedule, and nobody is blocked. A quotation cannot be conformed by the carrying project at all: altering it would make the citation disagree with the document it points at, which is a worse defect than the one being fixed. A quotation conforms when the quoted instrument is retitled, by being corrected to match.

Project 6 reports that **both** its live sites are quotations of CB-IB_Qualification_Standard’s title and neither is a use, withdrawing its earlier report that they would conform in the annex touch already scheduled — a correction that reduces its stated obligation rather than enlarging it, offered on the ground that an understatement of what a project can do is as much a defect in the record as an overstatement. Project 9 reports the same division across two of its own. So **at least four of the twenty-nine wait on a single retitling decision by Project 8** and on nothing else.

The count of twenty-nine stands. What changes is that “conformance is staged per instrument revision” has two meanings depending on which side a site falls, and a project reading its own load off an undivided figure will record work it cannot do. A later reading of these sites should say, per site, which kind it is. Project 1’s live masters carry the variant nowhere; it appears there only inside a conformance markup. Occurrences inside conformance markups, reconciliation records and this instrument’s own text are excluded — those name the variant in order to govern it.

Corrected in v0.4. v0.3 stated this figure as twenty-eight sites in eight live masters, which reconciled with neither reading of its own enumeration: the files it named are twenty-nine in nine, or twenty-seven in eight if Project 6’s live annex is set aside, and the paragraph set the annex aside in its prose while leaving the headline between the two. Project 8 found it by re-adding the per-file numbers. Every per-file number in v0.3 was exact and was verified independently on both sides; the arithmetic over them

was not. Recorded rather than silently amended, because this is a reading published inside a Foundational Definition and the paragraph immediately below tells a reader how much weight to give it.

This reading is a photograph and says so. It is accurate on the day it was taken and decays from that day; nothing should cite it as authority for how many sites remain. It is recorded because the first count offered — twenty sites in three instruments, all in one folder — was produced by reading the Command Broker family and generalising to the corpus, and the difference between the two figures is the whole of CR-VA in one line: verify against the applications, not against the set you screened.

FD-BL §4.5 and FD-SBL §4.5 — retain their domain-specific competence, substitutability, and independence content as restatements; add a reference to FD-BR as the source of the role-type and the pairing invariant. **FD-SBL has conformed:** its §4.5 cites FD-BR §4.1 and §4.2 (read 27 September 2026). **FD-BL has conformed at its v0.4, 27 September 2026.** Its §4.5 now cites FD-BR §4.1 and §4.2 and states the Command Broker's substitutability value and unit of authorization by pointer to FD-BL-D1. The stale *Open at this version* paragraph is gone. (v0.7 of this instrument recorded FD-BL as not conformed, which was true for the hours between the two issues.)

Surveillance corpus (Influence Broker architecture; Federal AI Influence Oversight Officer materials) — cite FD-BR; conform "Influence Broker" usage and derive the structural-independence requirement from §4.5.

The detailed diagnosis and replacement text for each instrument belong in the conformance schedule and are not reproduced here.

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8. Author Decisions Outstanding

Confirmation of the designation FD-BR and of its filing with the Foundational Definitions family (Project 0 / Cross-Project Alignment) alongside FD-BL, FD-SBL, FD-LD, and FD-EV. — CLOSED 27 September 2026, by the author. The designation is confirmed and the instrument is filed with the family in Project 0. It is a member of *FD — Foundational Definitions*, *September 2026 Edition*. **No author decision remains outstanding in this section.**

Confirmation that substitutability is stated as a *rule* here and as a *per-Line value* in each Line document (§4.4, §6.2), rather than being owned wholly by either side. — CLOSED 27 September 2026, by the author. The arrangement is confirmed. This instrument owns the substitution rule. Each Line document states its own value and its own unit of authorization by pointer to the determination that sets them, and the value binds back here by reference. The entry is retained, not struck, because the evidence beneath it is the record of why it closed. The rule was exercised prospectively on the surveillance Line and fits without strain onto the industrial Line.

Evidence received, 27 September 2026, on which the entry closed. Project 1 reports that FD-SBL-D2 is the first end-to-end exercise of the arrangement, and that it held: the rule is stated here, the value is determined in a determination under the Line, the Line states it by pointer, and it binds back here by reference (FD-SBL-D2 §8). The industrial side was read against the same question the same day. FD-BL-D1 determines the Command Broker's value but cites FD-BR nowhere, because it predates this instrument. FD-BL v0.3 neither stated the value nor cited this rule. **FD-BL v0.4 now carries both**: it states the value and the unit by pointer to FD-BL-D1 and cites FD-BR as the source of the role-type. So both Lines now hold the arrangement. The difference between them is how they came to hold it. On the

surveillance Line it was exercised prospectively: the value was determined with the rule in view. On the industrial Line it was conformed retrospectively, onto a determination made before the rule existed. The entry is the author's to close. The record now offers one prospective exercise that held, and one retrospective conformance that fits without strain.

Whether the Influence Broker's non-substitutability survives FD-SBL-D1, and on what ground. — CLOSED 5 September 2026. Opened, grounded and closed the same day. It is retained here rather than struck because the reasoning is the record of how the value was reached, and because §4.4's own ground was withdrawn in the course of it.

The closure. FD-SBL-D2 — Mode of Discharge v0.1 determines that advance discharge of the FD-SBL §4.5 authorization is not available and that the Influence Broker is not substitutable by a verified gatekeeper. FD-SBL v0.3 states that as this Line's value at §4.5 and closes its own §6.2 to a pointer. Read here from both masters rather than from the note announcing them. **The value binds into this instrument by reference under §6.2 and is not restated here**, at Project 1's request and on this instrument's own delegation rule.

The ground. FD-BL-D1 R2 requires a proof that the gatekeeper's acceptance set is a subset of the truly-safe set over state, trajectory and rate, and holds that where that proof cannot be produced, advance discharge is not available. FD-SBL §4.4 states of this domain that a deterministic micro-targeting model *"is bounded by proof of its outputs but not by proof of its societal effect; its manipulative consequence is precisely the thing not settled in advance."* R2's proof is the thing §4.4 says the domain does not supply. That is a better ground than this instrument's own, and it relocates the load: the result rests on the impossibility of the R2 proof, not on the difficulty of the human judgment. The residual §4.5 judgment and the I1–I3 requirements make an authorization rigorous without making it unmechanizable, and had they been the whole ground the result would have narrowed to partial substitutability instead.

The author has taken the weak claim: advance discharge is unavailable on present understanding, not foreclosed in principle. The physical sciences supply closed-form tools whose error bounds are themselves characterized and the social sciences do not yet, and the architecture should not dress a gap in the state of a discipline as a gap in the nature of things. A determination saying *never* would be falsified by a single advance and would take the surrounding structure with it.

What has changed is not that the result stayed contingent — it is what it is contingent on. v0.1 called the Influence Broker not substitutable *pending the FD-SBL §6.1 determination*, which was a question mark: pending an answer to whether manipulation is detectable. That determination is now made, and made the other way. The contingency that replaces it is a stated evidentiary threshold nobody can currently meet — a measurable predicate for manipulation defined on the action and independent of the operator's characterization, soundness over every admitted action, and completeness over composition, so that no sequence of individually non-manipulative actions composes into a manipulative campaign. The third course is the tall one and it is the direct analog of R2's anti-ratcheting clause. A question mark has become a specification.

And the result will have a fixed part and a contingent part. FD-BL-D1 R3 excludes envelope-changing actions from advance discharge under any construction, because no runtime gate can validate a change to its own safety basis. That reasoning is architectural rather than epistemic and does not depend on the state of social science. Envelope-changing actions therefore stay with the Influence Broker permanently; the rest stays until the threshold is cleared. A later opening opens only the second half.

Why the entry was held open rather than closed on the ground alone. §6.2 delegates the substitutability value to the Line documents and this instrument owns only the rule that sets it. Writing the conclusion in here would have taken back that delegation, in the instrument that owns the delegation rule — a structural defect that no later reader would have seen as an error. The entry closed when the Line document stated the value, which was hours later, and it closed on a reading of that instrument rather than on the note announcing it.

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9. Foundational References

Foundational Definitions and their determinations are cited here by designation, without version tokens. FD-REG holds the version state of FD-BL, FD-BL-D1 and FD-EV; FD-SBL-REG holds that of FD-SBL, FD-SBL-D1 and FD-SBL-D2.

FD-BL — *The Bright Line*. Eclectic Technologies, 2026.

FD-BL-D1 — *Mode of Discharge: Pre-Authorization by Verified Gatekeeper*. Eclectic Technologies, 2026.

FD-EV — *The Envelope*. Eclectic Technologies, 2026.

FD-SBL — *The Surveillance Bright Line*. Eclectic Technologies, 2026.

FD-SBL-D1 — *Indication Integrity and Substantive Authorization*. Eclectic Technologies, 2026.

FD-SBL-D2 — *Mode of Discharge*. Eclectic Technologies, 2026.

Command Broker Framework, Cross-Sector. Eclectic Technologies, 2026.

Command Broker / Influence Broker Qualification and Onboarding Standard (CB-IB). Eclectic Technologies, 2026.

Command Broker family instruments are cited in this document by designation, without version tokens. The current version of each is stated in **CB-REG**, which is the authoritative register for that family.

Roxey, T.E. *The Surveillance Bright Line: Mass Surveillance, Autonomous Influence Operations, and the Engineering Case for Democratic Safeguards in Federal AI Deployments*. Version 2.2. Eclectic Technologies, 2026. (The policy paper; distinct from FD-SBL above.)

Kilger, M. Reviewer comments on Surveillance Bright Line US Companion V2.2, 2026, the working title of the Version 2.2 paper above. (Domain source for the §4.3 Influence-Broker competence requirement (c24) and the §4.5 structural-independence requirement (c26).)

Record

This Record carries provenance moved out of §4.4 at v0.11. It is not part of the definition, and nothing in it varies §§1–9.

R.1 The withdrawn ground for the surveillance result

Until v0.11 the following two paragraphs stood in §4.4, after the paragraph on environments that are not proof-bounded. “This section” in them means §4.4. The “replacement” they describe is the ground §4.4 now states as the ground of the surveillance value.

The ground this section first gave for the surveillance case is withdrawn and is kept here as history. v0.1 and v0.2 grounded the Influence Broker’s non-substitutability on detectability: that manipulative influence is by design subtle and camouflaged, so there is no verifiable signal a gatekeeper could certify against (FD-SBL §6.1, as it then stood).

That ground was withdrawn and replaced on 5 September 2026, and the replacement is now determined in the Line document. FD-SBL §6.1 is no longer reserved — it was determined by FD-SBL-D1, on disk since August — and the determination does not lower the standard, it inverts the burden. The covert and unverifiable-basis classes are made **non-authorizable and prohibited**, so the system shall be incapable of executing them; what the Influence Broker authorizes is the transparent, verifiable-basis class within the permissible-influence boundary (FD-SBL-D1 §4.3). That boundary is a set of criteria checked at authorization, not an envelope in FD-EV’s reserved sense, because nothing is authorized in advance by lying inside it. The class this section uses to prove non-substitutability is, after D1, not a Broker-authorized class at all, and what remains in the Influence Broker’s hands sits close to the condition this section names as the one under which a Gate may stand in. The non-substitutability result does survive, and on a different ground, determined at **FD-SBL-D2** and stated as this Line’s value at FD-SBL §4.5. It does not survive on the ground this section originally gave.

Revision History

0.11 — 2 October 2026. Issued in the October 2026 Edition, and recorded in FD-REG v0.22 in the same act. One cumulative entry for the step of the Action Plan for the October 2026 Edition that opens this instrument (Step 4).

Step 4, 2 October 2026 (F-05, F-03; F-18, F-22, F-24, F-25, F-26). **F-05:** “Gate” stays in the triad at §4.1 as the enforcement interlock of FD-BL §4.5, and §4.1 states that it never authorizes and never stands in for the Broker. The object of §4.4 is the verified gatekeeper throughout, and §4.4’s heading, its first two paragraphs and §3’s substitution question are restated accordingly. §4.1 states that the consequence classifier sits upstream of the triad, owned by FD-BL §4.3 and FD-BL-D1 §5. **F-03, on the author’s determination of 2 October 2026 (Decision C, Option C1):** §4.1 states that a Broker discharges in the mode its Line permits, in the moment or in advance. §4.2 states that the pairing invariant holds across both modes: the human who authors and accepts a pre-authorized envelope is the Line’s Broker discharging in advance, not a second role. §4.3 makes advance-mode competence part of the one role’s competence. §4.4 states that what a verified gatekeeper substitutes for is the Broker’s presence at the moment of action, not the Broker’s judgment, keeps “substitutable” as the name of that property, and aligns the verb: the human discharges and the gatekeeper admits. **F-18:** new §2.5 carries the FD-EV declaration; the §5 gas example reads “pre-authorized envelope” for “fixed operating band,” and is restated in the two-mode terms. **F-26:** §4.5 states that this instrument owns “substantive” and “attributable” for every Line, and maps the asset owner-operator as the industrial instance of the deploying authority. **F-25:** the second Surveillance Bright Line entry in §9 is given the paper’s full title and distinguished from FD-SBL, the Kilger line names it as the paper’s working title, and the change numbering in the 0.7 entry is put in order, (9) before (10), without other change. **F-22:** “initial mapping” leaves the cover with the old version line. **F-24:** the two paragraphs of §4.4 recording the withdrawn

surveillance ground move to a new Record section (R.1), and §4.4 states the surveillance value and its boundary as they now stand. No section is renumbered except by the addition of §2.5 and the Record. **The subtitle changes**, on the author's decision of 2 October 2026: it read *"…the Competence That Qualifies It, and the Conditions Under Which Architecture May Stand in Its Place"* in v0.10 and in the August and September 2026 editions, and now reads *"…and the Conditions Under Which a Verified Gatekeeper May Stand in for Its Presence"*, so that the subtitle states what §4.4 now says. The designation and short title, *FD-BR — The Broker*, are unchanged, and citations by designation are unaffected.

Verification read, 2 October 2026. §4.4's second fixed class names a mechanism that admits actions under an authorization given in advance, rather than one "discharging authorization in advance," following the aligned verb. No change to placement, granularity, scope or obligation.

Review of 2 October 2026. On the author's instruction to apply the cold review of the October 2026 Edition review draft as recommended (FD-BL Reconciliation/Independent_Review_2026-10-02_FD_October_2026_Edition_Review_Draft_v0_1), this instrument takes findings G-06, G-14, G-15; each edit is quoted in the review's application record.

0.10 — 27 September 2026. Closes §8's last entry on the author's decision of this date: the designation FD-BR and its filing with the Foundational Definitions in Project 0 are confirmed. §8 now holds no outstanding decision. Issued as the version carried in *FD — Foundational Definitions, September 2026 Edition*. No other change.

0.9 — 27 September 2026. Closes §8's rule-and-value entry on the author's decision of this date. Substitutability is a rule in this instrument and a per-Line value in each Line document, and the unit of authorization is carried the same way. The entry is retained with its evidence rather than struck. One entry remains outstanding at §8, the confirmation of the designation and its filing. No other change.

0.8 — 27 September 2026. Records at §7 and §8 that FD-BL has conformed at v0.4, issued the same day. §7's *FD-BL has not* and §8's *run on one Line of two* are revised rather than left standing, because both had been falsified by that issue (CR-SC). The §8 rule-and-value entry stays open for the author, now with both Lines carrying the arrangement: one prospectively, one retrospectively. No other change.

0.7 — 27 September 2026. Conforms this instrument to the surveillance branch as revised on 26 September 2026, on the ten divergences Project 1 enumerated at FD-SBL-D2 §10 and noticed on 26 September. The divergences were read against the branch's masters of that evening (FD-SBL v0.5, FD-SBL-D1 v0.4, FD-SBL-D2 v0.3, FD-SBL-REG v0.5), all DRAFT and held from release. (1) §4.4's non-substitutable branch now states the weak claim, harm not bounded by proof, in the rule itself. (2) The ground is routed through §4.4's own rule on R2's standard, and not through FD-BL-D1's failure clause directly. The two fixed classes are attributed to FD-BL-D1 R3 as FD-SBL-D2 §7.1 carries it. (3) The stale *now in question there* sentence is replaced. (4) Reopening is bound wholly by reference to FD-SBL-D2 §6 and §7.3; the two points this instrument owns are stated: revision only, and to §4.4's standard. (5) *In-envelope* is replaced by the permissible-influence boundary, declared not an envelope in FD-EV's sense. (6) and (7) §4.3's Influence Broker competence drops the attribution to FD-SBL §4.5 and extends to liberty actions. (8) The unit of authorization is bound by reference at §4.4 and §6.2. The §5 example is rewritten as three cases, which also removes the *undetectable by design* sentence that still stated the withdrawn ground (CR-VA). (9) The §8 rule-and-value entry is **held open for the author**, with the evidence recorded beneath it and the finding that the industrial side has not been exercised the same way. (10) §9 drops version tokens, adds FD-BL-D1, FD-EV, FD-SBL-D1 and FD-SBL-D2, and gains a lead-in naming the two registers. §6.2's decayed present tense is corrected. §7 records that FD-SBL has

conformed and that FD-BL has not, including a stale *Open at this version* paragraph in FD-BL §4.5. The §7 variant reading of 5 September and the §8 closed entry are records and are unchanged. The production render 04_FD-BR_The_Broker_v0_6 is now one version behind.

0.6 — 5 September 2026. Closes §8's third author decision on a first-hand reading of FD-SBL-D2 v0.1 and FD-SBL v0.3: advance discharge is not available and the Influence Broker is not substitutable, stated as the Line's value at FD-SBL §4.5 and binding here by reference rather than restated. Resolves the withdrawal at §4.4 by naming the determined replacement ground and the two classes fixed regardless of the reopening condition, and corrects the §5 worked example, which after FD-SBL-D1 demonstrates the placement of the prohibited class rather than the Broker's non-substitutability. Records at §6.2 that the delegation now resolves to a value rather than to silence. Adds to the §7 reading the usage-versus-quotation division reported by Projects 6 and 9, under which at least four of the twenty-nine sites wait on a single retitling decision by Project 8 and cannot be conformed by their carrying projects — including both of Project 6's, which withdraws its earlier report that they would conform in its own next touch.

0.5 — 5 September 2026. Records at §8 that the ground for the Influence Broker substitutability question is in hand — FD-BL-D1 R2 read against FD-SBL §4.4, verified here against both masters — and that the author has taken the weak claim: advance discharge unavailable on present understanding, not foreclosed in principle. The decision is deliberately left open, because §6.2 delegates the value to the Line documents and stating it here would take back that delegation in the instrument that owns the delegation rule. Names the replacement ground at §4.4 without stating a result. Strips the two Command Broker family pins at §9 and adds the family lead-in: CB-REG issued at v0.1 on 5 September, so the register those citations resolve to now exists, which is the condition the v0.4 note set. Adds Project 6's archive exclusion to the §7 reading.

0.4 — 5 September 2026. Corrects the §7 site count from twenty-eight in eight to **twenty-nine in nine**, on Project 8's re-addition of the per-file numbers this instrument itself supplied. The method was sound and independently verified on both sides; the arithmetic over it was not, and the error stood in a dated reading inside a Foundational Definition. Records at §9 why the Command Broker pin stays repaired-to-current under Project 8's D1 and D2 determinations, and what converts it.

0.3 — 5 September 2026. Corrects, within hours of writing it, the §6.2 dependency paragraph that stated as fact that FD-SBL existed at two versions with content differing by copy. The two files are one text, character-identical, both at v0.2; only the markdown's filename misreports. The paragraph is restated rather than struck, because the real dependency it pointed at survives: FD-SBL states no substitutability value, so §6.2's delegation resolves to silence. Records at §4.4, §5 and §6.2 that FD-SBL §6.1 is determined rather than reserved — FD-SBL-D1, August 2026 — and that the determination inverts the burden the non-substitutability argument rests on, prohibiting the covert and unverifiable class rather than routing it to the Broker. Opens the corresponding author decision at §8 and does not resolve it. Repairs the §9 FD-SBL pin from v0.1, a version no surviving file holds, to v0.2. All of it on Project 1's reading, returned the same day.

0.2 — 5 September 2026. Records the author's confirmation of the canonical term and strikes the corresponding §8 entry. Corrects §6.1's scope, which named a single carrying instrument and read as an inventory: the reservation binds wherever the variant appears, and the site list moves to §7 as a dated reading with its method stated. Adds that reading — twenty-eight sites in eight live masters across three projects, against a first count of twenty in three, the difference being the corpus outside the folder that was screened. Repairs the stale inbound pin to the Command Broker Framework at §9, from v0.1 to the

v0.2 master, by re-pinning rather than stripping: reference-list form is the Class C population Project 0 deferred to Project 8's determination, and answering it here would be Project 0 taking back a question it handed over. Removes the version tokens from the header's companion line, which is operative text and within CR-CF's reach. The CB-IB pin at §9 is correct today and is left; the FD-SBL pin is left pending Project 1's answer on which copy of that instrument governs, recorded at §6.2.

0.1 — August 2026. Initial draft. Lifts the Broker from a framework-level role to a Foundational Definition. Declares the Broker a role that discharges a Bright Line's §4.5 obligation (§4.1); states the Line ↔ Broker pairing invariant and names Command Broker ↔ FD-BL and Influence Broker ↔ FD-SBL (§4.2); sets competence by the paired Line's placement criterion and makes qualification non-transferable (§4.3); owns the substitution rule under which a verified Gate may stand in for a Broker only in a proof-bounded environment, with the CB partially substitutable and the IB not (§4.4); makes independence a per-domain constraint set by incentive structure (§4.5); and reserves "Broker," "Command Broker," and "Influence Broker," conforming the CB-IB Standard's "Influencer Broker" (§6.1).